PRACTICAL OBSERVATION CHECKLIST (ASSESSOR'S COPY)

ABERDARE TECHNICAL COLLEGE

UNIT OF COMPETENCE: COMPUTER ESSENTIALS | UNIT CODE: 0611 351 01A

PRACTICAL 1, TERM 1 | ELEMENT COVERED: 2 MANAGE DESKTOP SETTINGS

Time: 2 Hours | Practical: 50 Marks | Product: 5 Marks | Oral: 30 Marks | Grand Total: 85 Marks

Section A: Candidate and Assessor Details

Candidate Details	
Candidate Name	
Registration / Admission No.	
Course / Level	
Class / Group	
Unit Name and Code	Computer Essentials - 0611 351 01A
Element Covered	2 Manage Desktop Settings
Workstation / Computer No.	
Operating System (Windows 10 / 11)	
Date of Assessment	
Start Time / End Time	

Assessor Details	
Assessor Name	
Staff / Registration No.	
Department	ICT
Assessor Signature	
Date	

Section B: Cutting List (Tools, Materials and Equipment Required)

The assessor confirms that the items below are available at each workstation before the assessment begins. This is a resource list for the practical; no items are cut.

S/No.	Item	Specification	Qty per Candidate	Available (Yes/No)
1	Desktop computer or laptop	Running Windows 10 or Windows 11, working and charged/powered	1	
2	Mouse	Working, USB/wireless or touchpad	1	
3	Keyboard	Working, USB/wireless or built-in	1	
4	User account	Permission to change personal settings	1	
5	Folder named “practical pictures”	Provided by instructor, at least three image files	1	
6	Notepad	Installed	1	
7	Calculator	Installed	1	
8	File Explorer	Available	1	
9	Settings app and Help feature	Accessible to the candidate	1	
10	Network / internet connection	For automatic date and time synchronization	1	
11	Practical sheet (candidate’s copy)	Printed, with space for observations and sign-offs	1	
12	Pen	For recording observations	1	
13	Recorded original settings	Original theme, background, taskbar alignment, text size, brightness (for Task 9 verification)	1 record	
14	Wall clock / stopwatch	For timing	1	
15	Assessment paper and this checklist	Printed	1 each	

Section C: Practical Observation Checklist (50 Marks)

Instruction to assessor: award the mark(s) only where the step is performed correctly without help. Award 0 where the step is not done or is done incorrectly. Record observations under remarks.

Task 1: Customize Desktop Icons (8 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
1.1	Changes the desktop icon size to Large, then to Medium (right-click desktop > View)	2		
1.2	Arranges the desktop icons by Name, then by Date modified (Sort by)	2		
1.3	Displays This PC, Recycle Bin and Network icons (Desktop icon settings)	1		
1.4	Creates a desktop folder named PRACTICAL followed by own name and places one icon inside it	2		
1.5	Renames one desktop icon, then changes it back to its original name	1		
	Task 1 Sub-total	**8**		

Task 2: Date and Time Settings (6 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
2.1	Opens the date and time settings of the computer	1		
2.2	Sets the time zone to the current location	1		
2.3	Displays the time in 24-hour format	1		
2.4	Sets the short date format to dd/MM/yyyy	1		
2.5	Turns on automatic setting of date and time	1		
2.6	Synchronizes the date and time (Sync now)	1		
	Task 2 Sub-total	**6**		

Task 3: Background Colour and Pictures (5 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
3.1	Changes the desktop background to a solid colour of choice	1		
3.2	Changes the desktop background to a picture of choice	1		
3.3	Sets the picture to fill the screen (Choose a fit: Fill)	1		
3.4	Selects a picture from the “practical pictures” folder	1		
3.5	Leaves the practical-pictures image applied as the final desktop background	1		
	Task 3 Sub-total	**5**		

Task 4: Themes (5 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
4.1	Applies the first built-in theme and observes changes in colours, sounds and background	1		
4.2	Applies a second, different built-in theme and observes the changes	1		
4.3	Switches the computer to Light mode and to Dark mode	1		
4.4	Observes and reports the effect of the modes on windows and menus	1		
4.5	Selects the preferred theme and leaves it applied	1		
	Task 4 Sub-total	**5**		

Task 5: Taskbar (6 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
5.1	Adds Notepad or Calculator to the taskbar (Pin to taskbar)	1		
5.2	Removes the application from the taskbar (Unpin)	1		
5.3	Sets the taskbar to hide automatically and observes its behaviour	1		
5.4	Turns the automatic hide setting off again	1		
5.5	Changes the taskbar icon alignment (Left or Center) and observes the change	1		
5.6	Hides the Search and Task View buttons, then displays them again	1		
	Task 5 Sub-total	**6**		

Task 6: Menu Bar (6 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
6.1	Opens the Start menu and pins an application to it	1		
6.2	Unpins the application from the Start menu	1		
6.3	Opens Notepad, identifies the menu bar items (File, Edit, Format, View, Help) and opens each menu	2		
6.4	Opens File Explorer and displays its menu options for viewing files (View menu)	1		
6.5	Shows file name extensions and hidden items, then hides them again	1		
	Task 6 Sub-total	**6**		

Task 7: Text Size (4 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
7.1	Increases the size of the text on the screen (Accessibility > Text size)	1		
7.2	Observes the change in text across Settings, File Explorer and Notepad	1		
7.3	Returns the text size to its original default value	1		
7.4	Records the text size percentage used and its effect in the observation space	1		
	Task 7 Sub-total	**4**		

Task 8: Brightness (3 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
8.1	Sets the screen brightness to its lowest level, then to its highest level	1		
8.2	Sets the brightness to a comfortable level of about 60%	1		
8.3	States the final brightness level in the observation space	1		
	Task 8 Sub-total	**3**		

Task 9: Restore and Clean Up (7 Marks)

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
9.1	Restores the original theme	1		
9.2	Restores the original background	1		
9.3	Restores the original taskbar alignment	1		
9.4	Restores the original text size	1		

No.	Observation Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
9.5	Restores the original brightness	1		
9.6	Deletes the PRACTICAL folder from the desktop and empties any items moved	1		
9.7	Closes all open applications and leaves the computer ready for the next user	1		
	Task 9 Sub-total	**7**		

Practical Checklist Summary

Task	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
Task 1: Customize Desktop Icons	8	
Task 2: Date and Time Settings	6	
Task 3: Background Colour and Pictures	5	
Task 4: Themes	5	
Task 5: Taskbar	6	
Task 6: Menu Bar	6	
Task 7: Text Size	4	
Task 8: Brightness	3	
Task 9: Restore and Clean Up	7	
Total Practical Marks	**50**	

Section D: Product Checklist (5 Marks)

The assessor evaluates the candidate's output and the final state of the computer after all tasks are completed.

No.	Product Quality Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
P1	Practical sheet is neatly completed, with legible observations (including Task 7 text size and Task 8 brightness)	1		

No.	Product Quality Item	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Remarks
P2	Instructor sign-off was obtained for each task before moving to the next	1		
P3	Only the settings named in the practical were changed (no unauthorised changes)	1		
P4	Computer is restored to its original state (theme, background, taskbar alignment, text size, brightness)	1		
P5	Desktop is clean: PRACTICAL folder deleted, all applications closed, computer ready for the next user	1		
	Total Product Marks	**5**		

Section E: Oral Checklist (30 Marks)

Instruction to assessor: ask each question orally and award marks according to the guide. Award partial marks (1 to 2) for partially correct answers. Ten questions at 3 marks each.

No.	Oral Question	Expected Answer (Marking Guide)	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
O1	Why would a user customize the size and arrangement of desktop icons? Name two ways of arranging icons.	Easier access, better organisation, suits eyesight and screen size; arrange by Name, Size, Item type, Date modified (3: reason, two ways)	3	
O2	Why is it important to set the correct date, time and time zone on a computer?	Accurate file timestamps, email and calendar, security certificates and updates, logs and scheduling; auto-sync keeps time correct via internet time server (3)	3	

No.	Oral Question	Expected Answer (Marking Guide)	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
O3	What is the difference between a 12-hour and a 24-hour time format? Give an example of the dd/MM/yyyy short date.	12-hour uses AM/PM (2:30 PM); 24-hour runs 00:00-23:59 (14:30); dd/MM/yyyy e.g. 21/10/2026 (3)	3	
O4	Name three picture-fit options for a desktop background and state what Fill does.	Fill, Fit, Stretch, Tile, Center, Span; Fill scales the picture to cover the whole screen, possibly cropping edges (3)	3	
O5	What is a theme, and what does it change? How do Light and Dark modes differ?	Theme is a ready set of background, colours, sounds and cursors; Light mode uses light colours, Dark mode uses dark colours, easier on eyes in low light and may save battery (3)	3	
O6	Explain the purpose of the taskbar and why a user might hide it automatically.	Launches and switches apps, shows Start, search, notifications and clock; auto-hide gives more screen space (3: purpose, two functions or reason for hiding)	3	
O7	What is the difference between pinning an app to the Start menu and pinning it to the taskbar?	Start pin places a tile/shortcut in the Start menu; taskbar pin keeps the icon always visible for one-click access; both can be unpinned without uninstalling (3)	3	
O8	Why would you show file name extensions and hidden items? Give one risk of leaving hidden items visible.	Identify file types (.txt, .docx, .jpg) and avoid wrong or disguised files; hidden items are system files that may be deleted or changed by mistake (3)	3	
O9	How does changing text size and screen brightness help users? What is a suitable brightness level?	Helps users with poor eyesight, reduces eye strain, saves battery; moderate level about 60% for comfort; too low or too high strains eyes (3)	3	

No.	Oral Question	Expected Answer (Marking Guide)	Max Marks	Marks Awarded
O10	Why must you restore settings at the end, and what can you use to find a setting you do not know?	Leaves the computer ready and unchanged for the next user and avoids confusion; use Settings search box and the Help feature / Get Help (3)	3	
	Total Oral Marks		**30**	

Section F: Marks Summary and Decision Outcome

Component	Max Marks	Marks Awarded	Percentage
Practical Checklist	50		
Product Checklist	5		
Oral Checklist	30		
Grand Total	**85**		

Overall percentage = (Total awarded / 85) x 100

Decision Outcome

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Decision	Tick (✓)
COMPETENT (Total of 50 marks or more)	
NOT YET COMPETENT (Total below 49 marks)	

Assessor's Comments and Feedback

Strengths observed:

_____

_____

Areas needing improvement:

_____

_____

Recommendation (e.g. proceed, reassess in tasks ____):

_____

Section G: Declarations and Signatures

Candidate's declaration: I confirm that the assessment was conducted fairly, I understand the outcome, and I was informed of my right to appeal.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Candidate			
Assessor			
Internal Verifier / Moderator			
Head of Department			

Appeal: The candidate may appeal in writing within the period allowed by the college's assessment policy.